Dear Player,

John Company is the result of nearly a decade of research, design, and development. It was a true labor of love and one that was only made possible through your support. We cannot thank you enough for making this game possible.

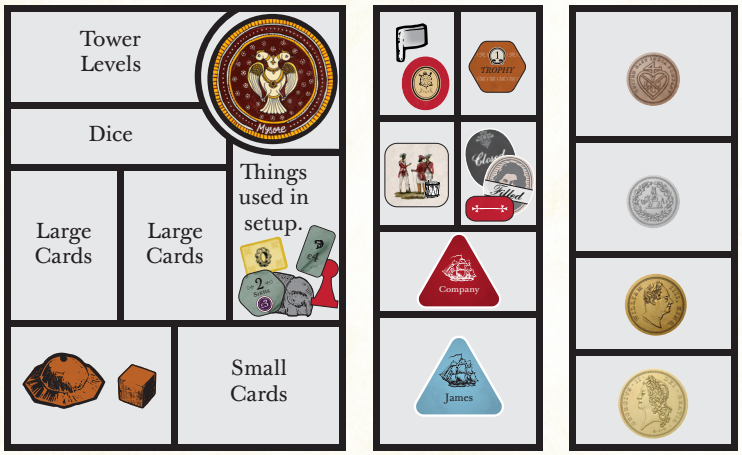
There's no disguising the fact that this is a big game, and it is best digested slowly. We would suggest first reading the introduction on the cover of the rules. Then, punch out all of the components and organize them in the trays as described in the image below. As you punch the pieces, take a moment to cross-reference them with the first few pages of the rules, which will tell you a little about what they are.

The top two trays are designed to be used during play. You can set them near the area of play to keep your table tidy. The bottom tray should remain in the box and is generally only used during setup.

Once you have a handle on the components, I'd suggest making a cup of coffee or tea and setting aside an hour or two to read through the rules. While you read, you should ideally unfold the board and take a look at the back page of this letter to get your bearings. Treat the process like learning a new roleplaying game. Though the individual elements of the game are straightforward, there are a lot of them. Take your time.

*Cole & Drew*

## Suggested Tray Organization




*Note: Not all components are pictured and there are many other ways to organize this game.*

*The bottom tray will accommodate sleeved cards, but they will take up to 50% more space, so you will need to use the tray's other compartments and may have to shift some pieces around.*

*When packing up the game, trays go on the bottom, then the board, then two stacks of player boards, then rules, then the bags of wooden components and large punch board (PM Dial) on top.*

## A Note on Teaching the Game

When introducing John Company to new players, consider using a "rolling teach." In this method, players will learn the game while playing. Before players arrive, complete the first 9 setup steps and choose the 1710 scenario. Remove the Governor General from the law deck.

When everyone is ready, spend the first five to ten minutes offering a general overview. You should describe the British East India Company and its three Presidencies. Then explain the game's objective, the sequence of play, and the difference between victory points and power.

Once you've done that, deal the setup cards and walk each player through setup, identifying what the various symbols on the setup cards mean. I suggest giving yourself the setup cards with the Chairman and Prime Minister as these can be confusing roles for new players.

Now, just start playing the game. As you get to each office, first describe its general function and then walk each player through their office card. Often it's helpful to offer to take their first action for them. Players will find that concepts build upon each other, and by the second turn they will often be ready to take off the training wheels. For now, don't worry about the finer points of negotiation. Players will figure those out on their own and you can offer some suggestions for deals during the second turn. Lastly, don't attempt to explain the Events in India phase during your first game. Instead, resolve it yourself while narrating what happens.

# The Game Board

## With Descriptions of Critical Areas




Yellow is the Chairman (a) and there are 4 pieces in the Company Shares box (b). Note that the Chairman also counts as a Company share for most purposes. Yellow also has a piece on the Stock Exchange (c) which may become a share later.

In this Presidency, Yellow is the President. It has £3 in its treasury, and 1 writer (Purple). The Presidency is associated with the region of Bombay as indicated by its flipped loot token (j).

Pink holds the office of Military Affairs (d) and any any officers in training are placed in the box above (e). In the Army of Bengal, Blue is the Commander (f). In that army there are 3 unexhausted pieces, 2 officers and 1 regiment (g). One officer (Pink) has already been exhausted (h) and there are 3 local alliances (i) which were either exhausted or not purchased this turn.

# Your Player Area

## And a Suggestion for A Tasteful Display of Holdings

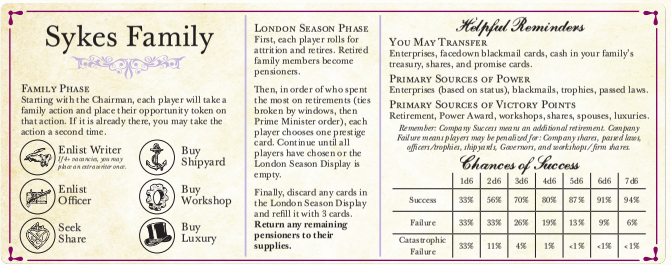
There are any number of ways to arrange your player area. Generally, you should keep your treasury and your offices in clear view and near to the board or to the right of your player board (this is best with narrow tables). Things that cannot be traded, such as your family pieces, any spouses, or trophies can be kept further away. Some players prefer to store their family pieces and treasury directly on their player boards to keep the area tidy.



*Family Treasury*

*The Offices you Control*
















*Your Promise Cards and Supply of Pieces*












*Your Enterprises (Small and on Prestige Cards)*

*Other Prestige Cards as well as Trophy and Passed Law tokens.*